



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*bhāvasya bhāvakaḥ kaścinna kiñcidbhāvako+aparaḥ |
ubhayā+abhāvakaḥ kaścidevameva nirākulaḥ | | 18 | 42 | |
śuddhamadvayamātmānaṁ bhāvayanti kubuddhayaḥ |
na tu jānanti saṁmohādyāvajjīvanirvṛtāḥ | | 18 | 43 | |*

— Aṣṭāvakraḡītā, Prakaraṇa 18 (Chapter 18), Verses 42-43

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

He speaks of three types of individuals: one who gets caught in the trap of constantly creating or dwelling on thoughts and feelings (bhava), another who remains detached from them, and a third, who transcends both creation and detachment, residing in a state of effortless peace. This third individual, free from the push and pull of mental activity, embodies true liberation.

The second verse highlights a common pitfall: the intellect attempting to grasp the pure, non-dual Self. Many, even with good intentions, try to conceptualize the Atman, the true Self, as something separate, something to be attained. They strive to purify and understand it through mental constructs, clinging to the idea of a "pure, non-dual Self" as an object of contemplation. However, Ashtavakra cautions that this very act of conceptualization, born from delusion (sammohat), prevents them from experiencing true liberation (nirvrita). They remain restless and unfulfilled throughout their lives, perpetually chasing a mental image of the Self instead of recognizing its ever-present reality.

In today's world, we are bombarded with information and expectations, constantly urged to improve ourselves, to achieve a better version of ourselves. We relentlessly analyze our thoughts and feelings, trying to fix what we perceive as flaws. Ashtavakra's words serve as a powerful reminder to step back from this endless pursuit. True liberation isn't about perfecting an image of ourselves but recognizing the inherent perfection of our being, right here, right now. It's about letting go of the need to constantly create or analyze our experience and resting in the spacious awareness that underlies it all. By ceasing our mental striving, we allow the true Self to reveal itself, not as a concept, but as a lived experience.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Can you identify areas in your life where you are striving to perfect a mental image of yourself, and how might letting go of that striving bring you closer to inner peace?